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Partnership to Impact: Aligning Systems for Regional Success

Presented by

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Audience Poll: How Coordinated Is Your Regional Workforce System?

1. We primarily coordinate programs
2. We occasionally plan together
3. We share regional goals
4. We have shared operating processes
5. We measure outcomes collectively

The Challenge: Why Collaboration Isn't Enough

Most regions have:

- ✓ MOUs
- ✓ Regular meetings
- ✓ Good intentions

But still experience:

- ✗ Duplicate services
- ✗ Confusing customer pathways
- ✗ Inconsistent employer engagement
- ✗ Limited ownership of regional goals
- ✗ Difficulty measuring system-wide impact

Coordination is an activity. Alignment is a system.

Ventura County's Starting Point

Our Question:

“How do we move from good partnerships to a truly integrated workforce system?”

We share the same starting point as most of the audience:

- Multiple partner agencies
- Shared customers
- Shared employers
- Independent funding streams
- Different organizational cultures

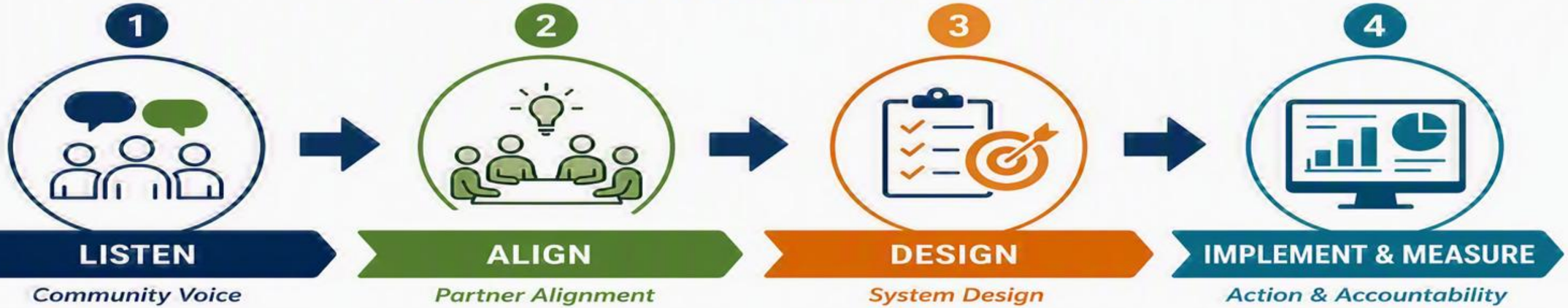


SECTION ONE

Building the Foundation

OUR STRATEGIC PLANNING FRAMEWORK

A partner-driven process from insight to impact



LISTEN
Community Voice

- Employer Focus Groups
- Job Seeker Focus Groups

ALIGN
Partner Alignment

- Strategic Planning Retreats
- Partner Visioning Sessions

DESIGN
System Design

- 4 Regional Goals
- 8 Shared SOPs

IMPLEMENT & MEASURE
Action & Accountability

- Dashboard
- Continuous Improvement
- Shared Accountability

Moving from input and insight to action and measurable outcomes.

BETTER OUTCOMES FOR JOBSEEKERS
More opportunities.
Stronger futures.

BETTER OUTCOMES FOR EMPLOYERS
Skilled talent.
Stronger businesses.

STRONGER REGIONAL PROSPERITY
Aligned systems.
Shared success.

Centering Community Voice: We Started with the Customer and Partners

Across all focus groups (Adult / Dislocated Worker / Youth, Employers, Partners), several recurring themes emerged:

1. Communication consistency matters as much as program quality
2. System complexity creates equity risks for customers
3. Trust, by employers and participants, is fragile
4. Staff transitions and workload pressures directly affect customer experience
5. Technology limitations undermine otherwise strong service delivery

Strategic Planning in Action: What Made This Different?

Instead of agency plans… We created:

1

Shared Ownership

2

Shared Priorities

3

Shared Accountability

STRATEGIC PLANNING IN ACTION

Moving from organizational priorities to a shared regional strategy

> *We didn't create another strategic plan*
> *We created a **shared operating framework.***



> ***Partnerships are not the outcome. Partnerships are the infrastructure.***
> **The outcome is better results for jobseekers, employers, and the region.**

SECTION TWO

The Four Cross-System Goals

The Four Cross-System Goals

These are our organizing framework for the next 3 years.

1. **AI Adoption and Workforce Transition**
2. **Talent and Skill Development**
3. **Employer Engagement**
4. **Partner Alignment and Resource Integration**

Preparing for AI and Workforce Transition

- Emerging industries [see handout]
- Staff readiness
- Customer digital literacy
- Future skills

“What AI-related workforce challenge is emerging in your region?”

Talent and Skills Development

1

Career navigation

2

Education alignment

3

Industry and career pathways

4

Equity and access

One Employer Strategy

CURRENT STATE

Multiple partner visits

FUTURE STATE

One coordinated employer approach

→ Shared intelligence on employer workforce needs and trends

→ Pathways that connect employers directly to talent development efforts

Alignment and Integration

What customers should experience:

NOT: Agency A → Agency B → Agency C

BUT: One Workforce System

- ✓ Customer Journey Mapping
- ✓ Strengthen cross-partner coordination and communication
- ✓ Improve service mapping and referral pathways for job seekers and partners

SECTION THREE

Turning Strategy Into Action

The Missing Link:
Why Strategic Plans Often Fail

Because they answer:

“What should we do?”

But not:

“Who does what differently on Monday morning?”

Standard Operating Procedures

8

SOPs Co-Developed

Example of cross-system integration:

Through a facilitated team-building process, partners surfaced system pain points and co-developed eight shared standard operating procedures (SOPs) to clarify roles, reduce duplication, and improve coordination across agencies.

SECTION FOUR

The Dashboard

If It Matters, Measure It

We did not want another strategic plan sitting on a shelf.
We built a dashboard.

What We Measure

AI Readiness

- Staff trained
- AI utilization

Talent and Skill Development

- Employment aligned with training pathways
- Training completion and persistence

Employer Engagement

- New employers engaged
- Employer satisfaction
- Repeat business engagement

Service Integration

- Cross-partner referrals
- Cross-partner activities

What We Learned About Shared Measurement

1. Measure the system, not just the programs
2. Start simple
3. Define ownership
4. Share results regularly
5. Use data for improvement, not punishment

Dashboard Overview

Executive Dashboard Scorecard

Measure	Baseline	Current	Target	Owner	Status	Indicator
AI Foundations Training	TBD		50%	OSO/Aliya		
AI Skill Readiness	TBD		TBD	Subrecipients		
Sector-Aligned Employment	28.6%		35%	Don		
Training Completion	TBD		TBD	Don		
Q2 Employment Rate	98.7%		Negotiated	Norman/Don		
Q4 Employment Rate	99.4%		Negotiated	Norman/Don		
New Employers Engaged	732		1,000	Cynthia/Program Managers		
Employer Satisfaction	83%		90%	OSO- Program Managers		
Employer Survey Responses	1-5/mo		100	OSO-Program Managers		
Cross-Partner Activities	TBD		+15%	Cynthia/Don		

What We Expect to Change

1

Relationships

Greater trust

2

Operations

Clearer processes

3

Outcomes

Better coordination and accountability

Five Lessons We Would Share

1. Start with community voice
2. Create goals together
3. Operationalize through SOPs
4. Measure collectively
5. Focus on progress, not perfection

?

Reflection Activity

What is one alignment challenge your region could address in the next six months?

Closing Thought

Partnership Creates Potential.

Alignment Creates Results.

Measurement Creates Impact.

Facilitators



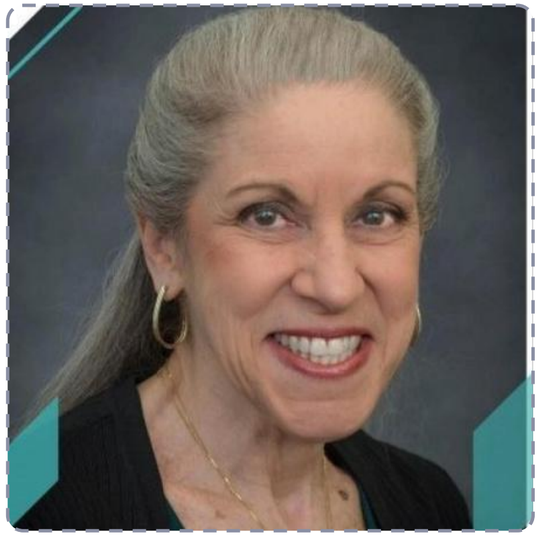
Norman Albances, Ph.D.

Assistant Director, Workforce Development Board of Ventura County

Serves as Assistant Director of the Workforce Development Board of Ventura County, where he helps oversee more than $20 million in workforce funding and programs connecting jobseekers to training and careers. He brings over 15 years of experience in workforce development, including WIOA program administration, strategic planning, grant management, and performance accountability. Dr. Albances has led innovation initiatives, secured competitive grant funding, and developed data-driven tools to improve system performance. A Lean Six Sigma Black Belt and Certified Workforce Development Professional, he is recognized for his systems-thinking approach and commitment to advancing equitable economic opportunity.

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Facilitators



Lori Strumpf

President, Strumpf Associates

Provides consulting services to many boards around the country, including in Ventura County. She currently serves as the One Stop System Operator for five workforce boards around the country, providing coordination and facilitation to WIOA partners as they work together to create a regional workforce system. She has been the interim Director for 5 workforce boards over the past 10 years. Strumpf Associates is a small cadre of training and consulting experts providing organizational change management consulting and executive coaching to schools, workforce organizations, and welfare organizations. Over the last several years, Lori has helped design and implement over 300 one-stop career development centers. Program management experience includes directing a U.S. DOL Workforce Innovation Grant for 665 disconnected young adults across 3 counties in Southern California, and three years as project director of a WIOA disconnected young adult program in Fredericksburg, Virginia.

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